

# DSP in VLSI

## Final Project

### Eigen-value Decomposition by Iterative QR Operations

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#### Development Environment

|                         |                        |
|-------------------------|------------------------|
| <b>HDL</b>              | SystemVerilog          |
| <b>Simulation Tools</b> | Synopsys VCS and Verdi |
| <b>Synthesis Tool</b>   | Synopsys DC Compiler   |
| <b>Process</b>          | TSMC 16nm (ADFP)       |
| <b>Verification</b>     | Python                 |

# Contents

|          |                                                                      |           |
|----------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>1</b> | <b>Section 1: Wordlength and RMSE Analysis</b>                       | <b>2</b>  |
| 1.1      | Minimum Fractional Wordlength & CORDIC Stage Selection . . . . .     | 2         |
| 1.2      | Integer Bit-Width Analysis . . . . .                                 | 3         |
| 1.3      | Fixed-Point Bit-True Model . . . . .                                 | 4         |
| 1.4      | CORDIC Scaling Factor . . . . .                                      | 4         |
| <b>2</b> | <b>Requirement 2: Bit-True Model Verification (11 Test Patterns)</b> | <b>5</b>  |
| <b>3</b> | <b>Requirement 3: Hardware Architecture and Control</b>              | <b>6</b>  |
| <b>4</b> | <b>Requirement 4: Hardware Simulation</b>                            | <b>7</b>  |
| <b>5</b> | <b>Requirement 5: Fixed-Point vs. Hardware Consistency</b>           | <b>8</b>  |
| <b>6</b> | <b>Requirement 6: Area-Time Product</b>                              | <b>9</b>  |
| <b>7</b> | <b>Requirement 7: Design Innovations and Team Contributions</b>      | <b>10</b> |

# Section 1: Wordlength and RMSE Analysis

## 1.1 Minimum Fractional Wordlength & CORDIC Stage Selection

To set the fixed-point parameters of the EVD bit-true model, we sweep the fractional wordlength and the number of CORDIC micro-rotation stages against all 11 matrices in `Final11Pattern.mat`. A configuration is accepted only when the RMSE of eigenvalues and eigenvectors both remain below  $10^{-2}$  for every test pattern:

$$\text{RMSE}_\lambda = \sqrt{\frac{1}{3} \sum_{i=1}^3 (\hat{\lambda}_i - \lambda_i)^2} \quad \text{RMSE}_v = \sqrt{\frac{1}{9} \sum_{i=1}^3 \|\hat{\mathbf{v}}_i - \mathbf{v}_i\|_2^2}$$

where  $\lambda_i$  and  $\hat{\lambda}_i$  are the reference and bit-true eigenvalues, and  $\mathbf{v}_i$  and  $\hat{\mathbf{v}}_i$  are the associated eigenvectors. We use a two-step search rather than tuning both knobs at once. First, with the CORDIC stage count fixed at 8, we increase the fractional wordlength  $b$  until the RMSE criterion is met on all 11 sets; the smallest such value is  $b = 11$ . Second, with  $b = 11$  held fixed, we sweep the CORDIC stage count and find that 8 stages is again the minimum setting that satisfies the same criterion. Thus, the selected bit-true configuration is **11 fractional bits** and **8 CORDIC stages**, which are adopted consistently in the subsequent verification and hardware implementation.

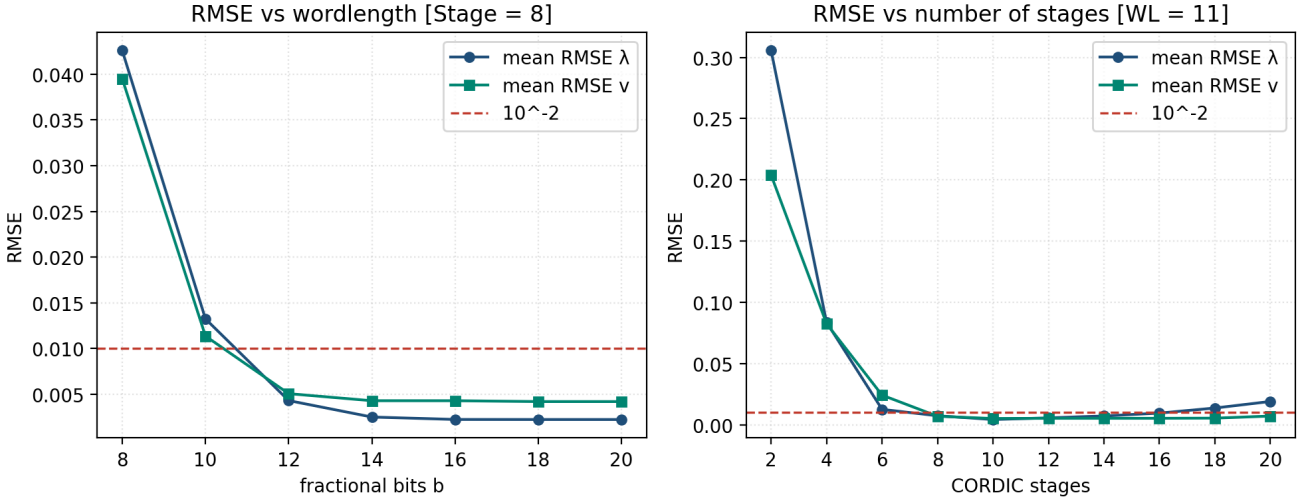


Figure 1.1: RMSE vs. fractional bits ( $N_{\text{stage}} = 8$ , left) and CORDIC stages ( $b = 11$ , right).

The two-step sweeps above are useful for intuition, but they do not jointly identify the smallest  $(b, N_{\text{stage}})$  pair. Each pass fixes one parameter at the value found earlier, so a configuration that fails in isolation may still satisfy the RMSE criterion when both knobs are set together, and the true minimum combination may be missed.

We therefore perform a two-dimensional sweep over fractional bits  $b$  and CORDIC stages  $N_{\text{stage}}$ . Every grid point is evaluated on all 11 test patterns; a setting passes only when both  $\text{RMSE}_\lambda$  and  $\text{RMSE}_v$  remain below  $10^{-2}$  for every set.

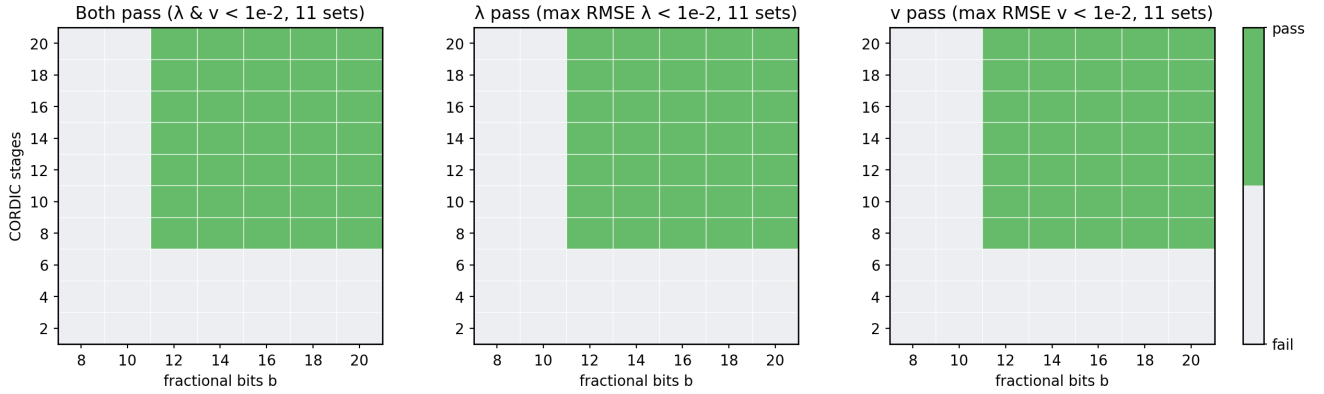


Figure 1.2: 2D pass maps over  $b$  and  $N_{\text{stage}}$  (11 test patterns).

Table 1.1 summarizes the hardware configuration selected from the sweeps above.

Table 1.1: Hardware Configuration

| Parameter                 | Value |
|---------------------------|-------|
| B (fractional bits)       | 11    |
| N_STAGES (CORDIC stages)  | 8     |
| MAX_ITER (max iterations) | 7     |

## 1.2 Integer Bit-Width Analysis

With the configuration in Table 1.1, we record the dynamic range of each EVD stage across all 11 patterns and derive the minimum integer wordlength needed at each node. Table 1.2 lists the worst-case integer bit requirement and the corresponding fixed-point format (1 sign bit + integer +  $B$  fractional bits).

Table 1.2: Integer Bit-Width Analysis

| Node            | Min     | Max    | Max abs | Int. bits | Q format | Total |
|-----------------|---------|--------|---------|-----------|----------|-------|
| Quantized input | -2.394  | 10.239 | 10.239  | 4         | Q4.11    | 16    |
| Matrix T/R      | -5.117  | 10.585 | 10.585  | 4         | Q4.11    | 16    |
| Eigenvector U   | -0.981  | 1.000  | 1.000   | 1         | Q1.11    | 13    |
| CORDIC input    | -5.117  | 10.585 | 10.585  | 4         | Q4.11    | 16    |
| CORDIC internal | -10.586 | 17.432 | 17.432  | 5         | Q5.11    | 17    |
| Scaled output   | -5.117  | 10.585 | 10.585  | 4         | Q4.11    | 16    |

### 1.3 Fixed-Point Bit-True Model

With the fractional wordlength, CORDIC stage count, iteration limit, and integer bit-width requirements established above, we implement a fixed-point bit-true model of the iterative QR EVD datapath. The model applies the formats in Tables 1.1 and 1.2 at each quantization point so that its arithmetic matches the behavior targeted by the RTL design.

This model supports more accurate fixed-point error analysis than a floating-point reference, because quantization, CORDIC rounding, and iterative accumulation are modeled explicitly. It also supplies golden eigenvalues and eigenvectors for RTL verification, so behavior and gate-level simulations can be compared against a consistent fixed-point reference instead of double-precision software alone.

### 1.4 CORDIC Scaling Factor

Section 1.1 applies gain compensation by dividing the rotated pair by floating-point  $K$ ; only the quotient is re-quantized to  $B$  fractional bits. The constant  $1/K$  itself is not quantized.

With ideal  $K$ , Table 1.2 shows that the main datapath fits in a **17-bit** word (worst case Q5.11). No wider format is needed for matrix registers, CORDIC rotations, or iterative updates.

Hardware must approximate  $1/K$  with a quantized constant. Raising  $B$  globally would widen the entire datapath even though the dynamic range analysis does not require it.

We therefore keep  $B = 11$  on the datapath and introduce a separate fractional wordlength  $B_K$  for  $1/K$  only. Each PE performs  $X \times (1/K)$  with locally widened precision and truncates the product back to the datapath width before the result is passed on. Extra bits are spent at this single multiply-and-round point, not across the systolic array.

Holding  $B = 11$  and  $N_{\text{stage}} = 8$  fixed, we sweep  $B_K$  independently. All 11 patterns meet the RMSE criterion ( $< 10^{-2}$ ) when  $B_K \geq 16$  (Table 1.3).

Table 1.3: CORDIC Scaling Factor Configuration

| Parameter                        | Value |
|----------------------------------|-------|
| B (datapath fractional bits)     | 11    |
| B_K (fractional bits for $1/K$ ) | 16    |

## **Requirement 2: Bit-True Model Verification (11 Test Patterns)**

## **Requirement 3: Hardware Architecture and Control**

## **Requirement 4: Hardware Simulation**



## **Requirement 5: Fixed-Point vs. Hardware Consistency**

## **Requirement 6: Area-Time Product**

## **Requirement 7: Design Innovations and Team Contributions**